

Advent Calendar — Quickstart

Add the metaobject-driven advent calendar section to an **existing** Shopify theme. Happy path, by hand in the Admin. Full reference: `INTEGRATION.md` .

Before you start

- A staff account with access to **Settings** → **Custom data** (metaobjects) and **Online Store** → **Themes**.
- The theme you will edit — duplicate it first (*Themes* → ... → *Duplicate*) so you work on a copy, then publish when happy.
- The `shopify-advent-calendar/` folder from this project. Only four subfolders go into the theme: `sections/` , `snippets/` , `assets/` , `locales/` .

1 • Add the section files to the theme

Online Store → **Themes** → ... → **Edit code** on your working copy. Add each file below with *Add a new section / snippet / asset* and paste its contents from `shopify-advent-calendar/<folder>/<file>` .

In the theme	Files to add
<code>sections/</code>	<code>advent-calendar.liquid</code>
<code>snippets/</code>	<code>advent-door.liquid</code> , <code>advent-overlay.liquid</code> , <code>advent-grid-defaults.liquid</code> , <code>advent-motif.liquid</code> , <code>advent-snow.liquid</code>
<code>assets/</code>	<code>advent-calendar.css</code> , <code>advent-calendar.helpers.js</code> , <code>advent-calendar.js</code>
<code>locales/</code>	<code>en.default.json</code> , <code>en.default.schema.json</code>

Locales: your theme almost certainly already has `en.default.json` and `en.default.schema.json` . Do *not* overwrite them — open each, and merge in the single key:

```
{ "sections": { "advent_calendar": { "no_entry": "Select an Advent calendar entry i
```

Both files can carry the same key.

FASTER ALTERNATIVE With Shopify CLI: `shopify theme push --theme <id> --only`

`"sections/advent-calendar.liquid" --only "snippets/advent-*" --only "assets/advent-calendar.*" --only "locales/*"` . Never push the whole folder over a live theme.

2 • Create metaobject definition — `advent_calendar_day`

Settings → **Custom data** → **Metaobjects** → **Add definition**. Name it **Advent Calendar Day**; confirm the type handle is exactly `advent_calendar_day` . Add these fields (the key must match exactly):

Key	Type	Required	Validation
day	Integer	Yes	min 1, max 25
title	Single line text	Yes	—
message	Rich text	Yes	—
code	Single line text	No	—
motif	Single line text	No	Preset choices (10, below)
image	File	No	Images only
link_url	URL	No	—
link_label	Single line text	No	—
grid_area	Single line text	No	— (layout override, step 7)
grid_area_mobile	Single line text	No	—

motif preset choices, exactly these ten, in order: wreath, candle, star, gift, tree, bell, snowflake, stocking, bauble, candycane. Empty / unknown falls back to wreath. There is deliberately no size field — a door's size is the two span values inside grid_area.

3 · Create metaobject definition — advent_calendar

Add definition → name **Advent Calendar**, handle advent_calendar.

Key	Type	Required	Notes / default
heading	Single line text	Yes	—
subheading	Single line text	No	—
background_color	Color	No	#1c1613
text_color	Color	No	#f6ede0
door_color	Color	No	#2a3d35
door_text_color	Color	No	#cfe3d4
accent_color	Color	No	#c9a24b
show_snow	True / false	No	default true
start_date	Date	No	door N opens on start_date + (N-1) days; empty → day N of December this year
days	Metaobject list	Yes	list of Advent Calendar Day entries

For days: add field → **Metaobject** → turn on *List of entries* → point the reference at the **Advent Calendar Day** definition.

4 · Turn on storefront access

For **both** definitions: open the definition → **Storefront access** (a.k.a. Access → Storefronts) → enable **Web**. Without this the section renders nothing.

5 · Create the 25 day entries + the parent

1. **Advent Calendar Day** → **Add entry**, once per day. Set `day` to the number, fill `title`, `motif`, `message` (type straight into the rich-text editor — plain paragraphs are fine), and `code` where wanted. Leave `grid_area` / `grid_area_mobile` empty to use the built-in mosaic. Set status **Active**. Content to use: `INTEGRATION.md §5.1` (ported from the React version) — or your own.
2. **Advent Calendar** → **Add entry**. Fill `heading` (+ any colours / `show_snow` / `start_date`). In `days`, add all 25 day entries **in order 1 → 25**. Status **Active**.

SCRIPT ALTERNATIVE From `shopify-advent-calendar/` with Node ≥ 18 and a custom app token (`write_metaobject_definitions`, `write_metaobjects`, `read_metaobjects`): `cp scripts/.env.example scripts/.env`, fill it in, then `npm run create-defs` and `npm run seed` — this does steps 2, 3 and 5 for you (still verify step 4). See `INTEGRATION.md §6`.

6 · Add the section to the theme

1. **Online Store** → **Themes** → **Customize** on your working copy.
2. Pick a template (or a section group that accepts sections) → **Add section** → “**Advent calendar**”.
3. In the section settings, under **Content**, set **Advent calendar** to the parent entry from step 5. If the picker is missing on your theme version, use the “*...or entry handle*” text field and type the entry's handle (e.g. `advent-calendar-default`).
4. **Save**.

7 · Check it, then publish

- **Preview day** (section setting): set 1–25 to walk the doors through locked → today → past; `0` = real date.
- `?day=13` on the preview URL: client-side override to test outside December.
- Open a door → the overlay animates from it; Esc / clicking the backdrop closes it; opened doors are remembered per browser.
- **Layout tweaks:** to move or resize a door, set its `grid_area` to “`<row> / <col> / span <height> / span <width>`” (1-based; e.g. `1 / 5 / span 2 / span 1`). Turn on **Show layout guides** in the section settings to see holes / overlaps flagged. Grid size is fixed at 7×8 desktop / 4×14 mobile in the settings; if you change it, re-balance every door. Full table + rules: `INTEGRATION.md §8`.
- Colours: the section's *Style overrides* beat the metaobject colour fields, which beat the built-in defaults. Keep text-on-background and door-text-on-door at WCAG AA.
- When it looks right: **Themes** → ... → **Publish** the working copy.

If something's wrong

Symptom	Check
Section shows "Select an Advent calendar entry..."	Step 6.3 — the Advent calendar setting (or handle fallback) is not pointing at the parent entry.
Section renders nothing / blank	Step 4 — storefront access not enabled on one or both definitions. Also confirm the parent entry and its 25 days are Active , not draft.
All doors locked in December	Expected before day 1, or if <code>start_date</code> is a future date. Use Preview day to check.
Wrong icon on a door	<code>motif</code> value must be one of the ten preset choices (step 2), lowercase.
Doors overlap / gaps in the grid	A custom <code>grid_area</code> broke the tiling. Turn on Show layout guides ; clear the field to fall back to the default.
Theme editor didn't update after editing a metaobject	Metaobjects are a separate Admin screen — go back to Customize and refresh the preview.

Advent Calendar for Shopify · quickstart. Full reference: `shopify-advent-calendar/docs/INTEGRATION.md` .

Regenerate this PDF from `quickstart.html` (see the comment at the top of that file).